Examination Policy

Superior University

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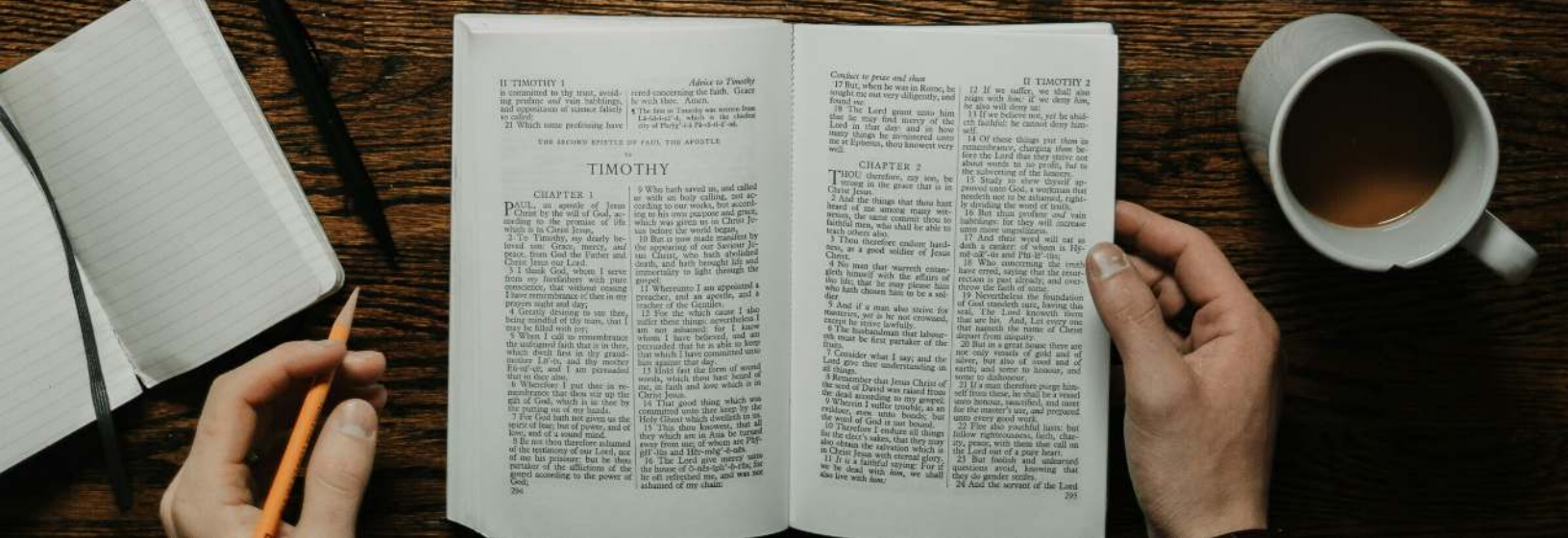

Examination Policy for ODL Mode

Introduction:

This policy outlines the guidelines and procedures for conducting assessments at the university/institute in the Open and Distance Learning (ODL) mode. The policy ensures the integrity, fairness, and transparency of the assessment process, focusing on infrastructure, software requirements, question bank management, exam scheduling, paper generation, assessment conduct, evaluation, and result preparation. While internal assessments may be conducted virtually, the final term exam is subject to additional security measures.

1. **Infrastructure Requirements** To ensure a secure and uninterrupted assessment process, the following infrastructure requirements must be met:
   - **Computer Lab Setup:**
     1. A computer lab with adequate capacity to accommodate students taking the final term examination simultaneously.
     2. Workstations equipped with a minimum of a Core i5 Processor (6th Generation or above) and at least 4 GB of RAM.
     3. Workstations must be interconnected via a local LAN with domain-based networking.
     4. Workstations should run on Windows 10 or higher.
     5. A stable internet connection with a backup is mandatory to prevent disruptions.
   - **Power Backup:**
     An adequate electricity backup system, such as UPS, generators, or solar power, must be in place to ensure continuous power supply.
   - **Security Measures:**
     CCTV cameras must cover all areas of the lab, including entrances, to monitor the examination environment.
2. **Exam Software Requirements:**
   To maintain consistency and functionality, the following software requirements must be adhered to:
   - **Software Installation:**
     1. A safe exam browser must be installed on all workstations, ensuring secure login, automatic saving of answers, and locking of workstations during the exam.
     2. The software should support proctoring and supervisory control.

3. **Question Bank Management:**
   The question bank is a critical component of the assessment process and should be managed as follows:
   - **Question Bank Setup:**
     1. A separate question bank must be maintained for each course or topic, mapped to specific Student Learning Outcomes (SLOs) and Program Learning Outcomes (PLOs).
     2. Questions should be categorized by difficulty level according to Bloom's taxonomy.
   - **Regular Review:**
     The question bank should be periodically reviewed and updated to ensure relevance and accuracy.
4. **Date Sheet Mechanism:**
   To provide flexibility to students, the following date sheet mechanism will be implemented:
   - **Registration & Exam Center:**
     1. Students must register for exams during the announced period and select their examination city/center for the final term exam.
     2. Teacher can allow students to create their own date sheet within the designated examination period for internal assessments.
5. **Question Paper Generation:**
   To ensure fairness and security in the assessment process, the following guidelines are established:
   - **Course-Based Question Papers:**
     Question papers will be generated based on the relevant course content.
   - **Individualized Papers:**
     1. Each student will receive a unique paper, with questions randomly selected from the question bank.
     2. All question papers must be encrypted and password-protected to prevent unauthorized access.
6. **Conduct of Assessments:**
   Assessments will be conducted in a secure environment, with distinct protocols for internal assessments and final term exams:
   - **Internal Assessments:**
     Internal assessments, including quizzes, SEQs, essay-based questions, true/false, and matching, will be conducted without the need for a physical examination center. These assessments must be administered using a safe exam browser, with proctoring, time restrictions, and randomized questions to ensure security. For assignments and projects, a plagiarism test is mandatory.
   - **Final Term Examinations:**
     Final term exams will be conducted in approved examination centers under strict supervisory control, with proctoring and the use of a safe exam browser to ensure academic integrity.

7. **Evaluation Strategy:**
   To ensure fair and unbiased evaluation, the following strategy will be employed:
   - **Systematic Marking:**
     1. Answer papers will be marked systematically, with student identification hidden to maintain impartiality.
     2. Marking will be done on a question-by-question basis to ensure consistency.
8. **Result Preparation and Declaration Mechanism:**
   The following procedures will be followed to prepare and declare assessment results:
   - **Compilation:**
     Results will be compiled on a subject/course-wise basis.
   - **Error Detection:**
     A system will be in place to identify and rectify any anomalies in the results.
   - **Grade Assignment:**
     Grades will be assigned in accordance with the Higher Education Institution's (HEI) approved grading policy.
9. **Assessment and Feedback**
   - **HEC Compliance:**
     1. **HEC Compliance:**
        Ensure the assessment process complies with the policies, rules, and regulations issued by the HEC.
     2. **Assessment Policy:**
        Develop a rigorous process for creating and moderating question papers, assignments, and exams, ensuring that they are conducted by qualified teachers.
     3. **Assessment Types:**
        Incorporate both formative (Assignments/Quizzes/GDB) and summative (mid and end semester exams) evaluations.
     4. **Practical Work:**
        Conduct and evaluate practical work (if any) through traditional face-to-face modes, ensuring completion before semester exams.
     5. **Examination Centers**:
        Establish examination centers within HEIs or other approved institutions, complying with statutory body requirements.
   - **Assessment Design**
     1. **Objective Measurement:**
        Ensure assessments measure the achievement of stated learning objectives or competencies across all learning domains (cognitive, affective, psychomotor).
     2. **Grading Policy:**
        Clearly state the course grading policy at the beginning of the course.
     3. **Evaluation Criteria:**
        Provide specific and descriptive criteria for evaluating learners' work and explain how it connects to the grading policy.

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7. **Variety of Assessments:**
   Use a variety of assessments (e.g., discussions, assignments, quizzes) suited to the course level.
8. **Feedback Opportunities:**
   Provide learners with multiple opportunities to track their progress with timely feedback.
9. **Sample Assignments:**
   Include sample assignments to illustrate instructor expectations.
10. **Rubrics:**
    Use rubrics to evaluate assignments and/or discussions.
11. **Mastery Tracking:**
    Enable a Learning Mastery Grade-book for visual representation of outcome mastery.
12. **Self-Assessment:**
    Provide opportunities for students to review their performance and assess their own learning through pre-tests, self-tests, or elective assignments.
13. **Timed Responses:**
    Inform students when a timed response is required, providing adequate lead time.
14. **Grade Book Access:**
    Ensure students have easy access to a well-designed and up-to-date grade book.
15. **Feedback Mechanisms:**
    Provide students with multiple opportunities to give feedback on course design, content, experience, and technology.

10. Review and Continuous Improvement

- **Periodic Review:**
  Conduct a comprehensive review of course contents, materials, and activities at least every three years to ensure alignment with societal demands and learning outcomes.
- **Continuous Refinement:**
  Update assessment materials and make necessary adjustments every semester to ensure relevance and effectiveness.

Conclusion: This online assessment policy is designed to maintain the highest standards of academic integrity and provide students with a reliable assessment experience. By following these guidelines, the institution ensures that all assessments, whether internal or final term, are conducted securely, fairly, and efficiently.

Automation and Policy Control Department

The Automation and Policy Control Department at Superior University Lahore plays a critical role in managing and optimizing institutional processes by focusing on two major projects: ERP (Enterprise Resource Planning) and ODL (Open and Distance Learning). Through the implementation of ERP, the department streamlines administrative, academic, and financial operations, ensuring efficient resource management and data-driven decision-making. Simultaneously, the department supports the ODL initiative, enabling flexible and accessible education for a diverse student body through the integration of technology-enhanced learning platforms and robust policy frameworks. This dual focus ensures that Superior University remains at the forefront of innovation in both administrative efficiency and educational accessibility.

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